

Shiva Temple Discovery for India

A proposal for turning Indian location data and bounded place search into a transparent, reproducible pipeline of Shiva temple candidates for independent verification.



THE OPPORTUNITY

The temples already exist. Bholenath makes their discovery systematic.

India's temple landscape is culturally rich, locally named and unevenly documented. The first problem is not publishing a final directory. It is building a repeatable way to find likely records, preserve how they were found and make them reviewable.

Location data -> bounded search -> candidate evidence -> review

785

LGD DISTRICTS

Frozen Phase 1.1 administrative baseline.

7,065

SEARCH TASKS

Nine bounded Shiva-related queries per district.

74,117

CANDIDATE RECORDS

Unique district-attributed Google Place IDs.

59%

HIGH CONFIDENCE

Strong Shiva name signal, not verification.

BOUNDARY

These are observed discovery records from a dated Google Places run. They are not the exact number of Shiva temples in India and not an official cultural census.

02

Temple information is visible. A reliable national view is still hard.

Names, scripts, listings and administrative references vary. Search results overlap. Geography and platforms change. Without a controlled pipeline, counts become impossible to explain or reproduce.

01 / NAMES VARY

Shiva, Shiv, Mahadev, Shankar, Vishwanath, local spellings and regional scripts.

02 / SOURCES DIFFER

Administrative geography and place listings answer different questions.

03 / RESULTS REPEAT

The same Place ID can appear across keywords and nearby search locations.

04 / EVIDENCE IS INCOMPLETE

A discovered name is a lead. Identity, history and location still require independent review.

- Resolve official location identities before search
- Keep each query-to-place observation
- Deduplicate by a stable external reference
- Separate confidence signals from verification decisions

WHAT WE BUILD

A discovery and evidence layer for Shiva temple candidates.

Bholenath connects official location data, bounded search tasks, place observations and name-based classification - then makes each record inspectable without presenting discovery as cultural truth.

IMPORT

SEARCH

OBSERVE

DEDUPE

CLASSIFY

EXPORT

01 / IMPORT

Normalize official Indian location records and preserve hierarchy.

02 / GENERATE

Create one safe, reviewable search task per place and keyword.

03 / DISCOVER

Call Google Places Text Search with strict limits and narrow fields.

04 / DEDUPLICATE

Keep one current candidate per Google Place ID, plus observation history.

05 / CLASSIFY

Score discovered names as high, medium or low Shiva confidence.

06 / REPORT

Export national, state, district and candidate review datasets.

ASK A DISTRICT QUESTION

Which Shiva temple candidates were discovered here, and what evidence supports each result?

Bholenath should let a researcher move from a district summary to an individual candidate, then inspect the source query, discovered name, Place ID, confidence reason and observation history.

The record is useful only when the user can see what is known, what is inferred and what is still unverified.

SUMMARY

RECORD

EVIDENCE

METHOD

LIMITS

BHOLENATH / CANDIDATE RECORD

Example Shiva temple candidate

SOURCE QUERY

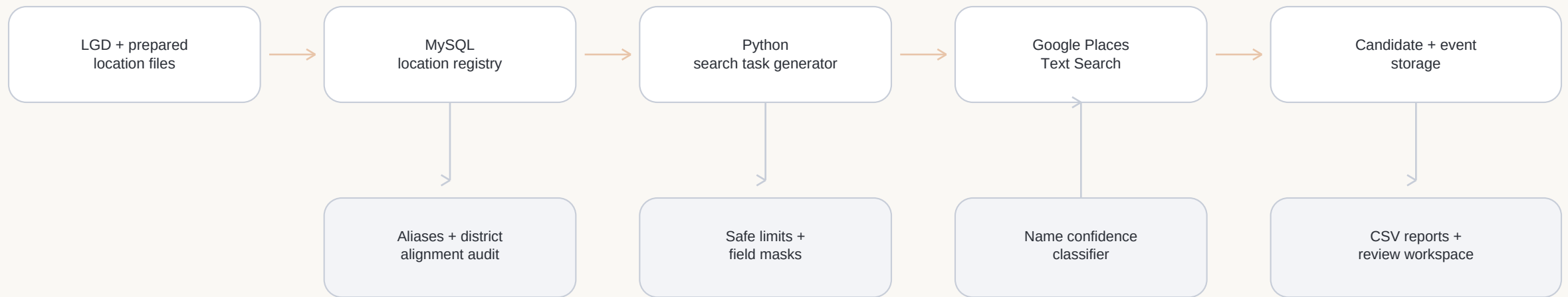
Mahadev temple in [district], [state], India

EVIDENCE PACKAGE

- Discovered name + address
- Google Place ID + Maps URI
- Search task + source location
- Confidence score + reason

Use different systems for different jobs.

Official geography anchors search scope. MySQL holds locations, tasks, candidates and evidence. Python runs deterministic discovery and classification. The portal explains the resulting dataset.



ARCHITECTURE PRINCIPLE

Discovery finds candidates. Verification establishes truth

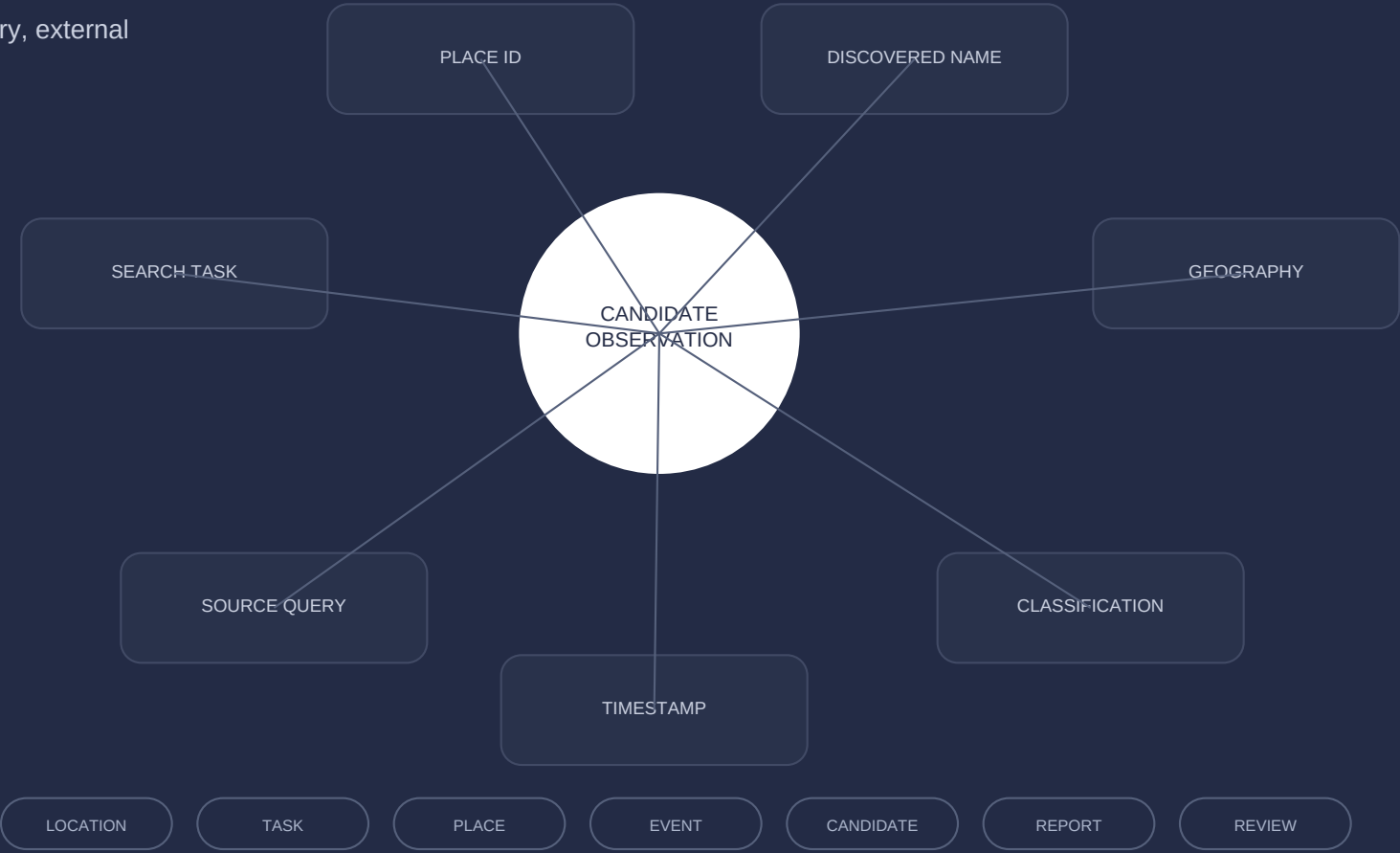
THE FOUNDATIONAL OBJECT

Candidate observation

A place returned by a specific bounded search, tied to a source location, query, external ID, timestamp and classification result.

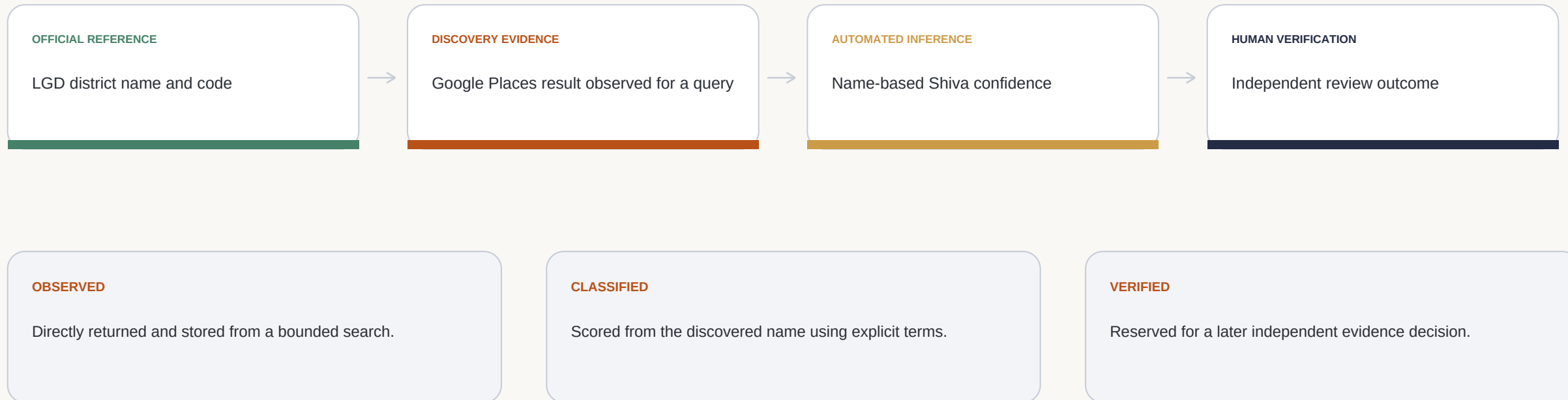
EXAMPLE FIELDS

Discovered name: [candidate name]
Geography: [district], [state]
External identity: Google Place ID
Source query: [keyword] in [location]
Confidence: high / medium / low
Status: pending independent verification



Every result should carry its limits.

Bholenath's credibility comes from keeping administrative truth, discovery evidence, automated inference and human verification separate - while making the path between them visible.



Confidence is a triage signal. It is not proof of identity, history, affiliation, boundaries or continued existence.

START NARROW

A district baseline before deeper geography.

Phase 1.1 uses active LGD districts only. Towns, urban local bodies, sub-districts and villages are excluded so the baseline remains comparable and auditable.

785

DISTRICTS

Active LGD rows

7,065

TASKS

Completed searches

74,117

CANDIDATES

Unique Place IDs

INTERPRETATION

A reproducible discovery baseline of likely candidates - not the number of Shiva temples in India.

OBSERVED SNAPSHOT

May 5-17, 2026

229,495

raw discovered occurrences

155,378

repeats removed across queries

43,877

high-confidence name matches

7,366

medium-confidence candidates

22,874

low-confidence possible records

772

districts with at least one candidate event

Dataset status: district_level_discovery_count_not_final_cultural_count

Expand geography without contaminating the baseline.

Phase 1.1 is frozen as a district-only release. Each later layer should be versioned separately, use the same safety controls and earn its way into combined views through validation gates.

PHASE 1.1

DISTRICT BASELINE

COMPLETE

785 active LGD districts; 7,065 tasks; frozen release.

PHASE 1.2

TOWN + ULB

NEXT

Prepare authoritative locations, size the task budget and run a bounded pilot.

PHASE 1.3

SUB-DISTRICT

LATER

Add tehsil or sub-district searches only after overlap rules are tested.

PHASE 1.4

SELECTIVE VILLAGES

LATER

Use targeted pilots where local coverage justifies the cost and complexity.

CORE WORKSTREAM

Location preparation + task budgeting + safe discovery + event lineage + scoped reporting

GATE BEFORE SCALE

Authority checked, duplicate scope understood, query budget approved, tests green, dataset version named

SUCCESS MEANS RELIABILITY

What Phase 1 must prove

- 01 Coverage:** Every in-scope location has an explicit search status.
- 02 Identity:** Candidates deduplicate by Google Place ID.
- 03 Lineage:** Each observation connects to its query and source location.
- 04 Reproducibility:** The same snapshot yields the same classified reports.
- 05 Safety:** Task, page and field limits prevent uncontrolled runs.
- 06 Clarity:** Every output distinguishes discovery, confidence and verification.

EXPLICIT NON-GOALS

What Bholenath is not

Not a temple census

The dataset does not measure the exact real-world population.

Not verified by default

A name match does not establish identity or heritage.

Not a scraped directory

Collection is bounded and source-aware.

Not a ranking of sanctity

Confidence is operational triage, not spiritual judgment.

Not boundary truth

Search attribution does not prove that a pin lies inside a district.

Not final public knowledge

Discovery records require independent evidence and review.

THE MOAT IS NOT A NUMBER

The valuable asset is accumulated evidence quality.

Search results will change. The durable value is the project's ability to explain what was searched, what was observed, how identity was handled and what still needs review.

Build evidence quality before geographic quantity.

District -> town / ULB -> sub-district -> selective village

01

Location registry

Official names, codes, aliases, hierarchy and active scope.

02

Observation ledger

Task-to-place events that preserve how candidates were found.

03

Classification lexicon

Explicit Shiva terms, scores and reasons that can be tested.

04

Review corpus

Human evidence decisions that improve future prioritization.

05

Versioned snapshots

Frozen datasets that keep analysis comparable over time.

06

Evaluation suite

Known-good cases for dedupe, classification and reporting.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Build Phase 1.2 as a separate, bounded location layer.

Preserve the Phase 1.1 district release unchanged. Prepare authoritative town and urban local body inputs, quantify the search budget, run a small pilot, evaluate overlap and only then authorize wider discovery.

SOURCE

NORMALIZE

BUDGET

PILOT

EVALUATE

VERSION

THE BHOLENATH TEST

Does this make a candidate easier to discover, trace and independently verify?

If not, it probably does not belong in Phase 1.

The temples already exist.
Bholenath makes their discovery systematic.

PRIMARY REFERENCES

Public and project references used in this proposal

Shiva Temple Discovery workspace

<https://jaibholenath.com/>

Current public theme, terminology and district-first data presentation.

Local Government Directory - Districts

<https://data.gov.in/resource/local-government-directory-lgd-districts>

Administrative district names and LGD codes for the Phase 1.1 baseline.

Google Places Text Search (New)

<https://developers.google.com/maps/documentation/places/web-service/text-search>

Bounded place discovery using text queries, type filters, field masks and Place IDs.

Project repository

[README.md](#); [docs/DATA_POLICY.md](#); [docs/PHASE_1_1_DISTRICT_BASELINE.md](#)

Implementation scope, safety limits, data language and frozen release notes.

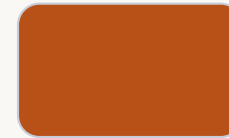
VISUAL DIRECTION

Bholenath's website identity, translated into an editorial proposal

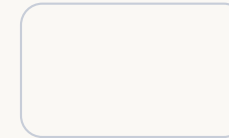
The layout borrows the Drishti proposal's disciplined pacing - oversized statements, alternating light and dark pages, thin rules, rounded panels and diagram-led storytelling - while using Bholenath's own palette and typography.



INDIGO



SAFFRON



IVORY



GREEN

TYPOGRAPHY

Georgia for the temple-story voice.
Inter-style system sans for evidence, labels and data.

STATUS

Internal concept proposal. Phase sequencing and future expansion remain planning decisions. Snapshot figures are discovery records, not verified real-world temple counts.